



COURSE SLIDES

Claude Microsoft 365 Masterclass (C197)

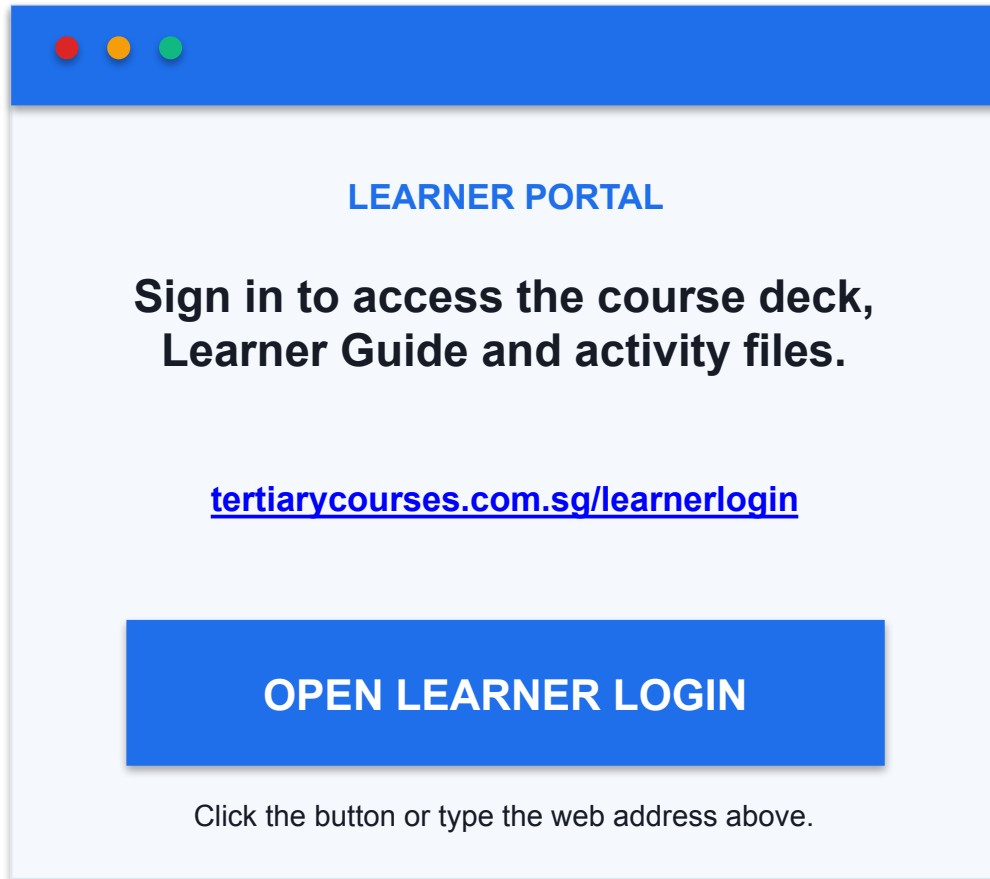
Course Code: C197

Conducted by Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte Ltd · UEN 201200696W

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Download Your Course Materials



Use OTP to sign in

- 1 Enter the email address registered for your course.
- 2 Choose OTP sign-in and request a code. Check your registered email.
- 3 Enter the OTP, open C197 and download your materials.

Cannot receive the OTP? Use password sign-in

Same registered email · Password: student12345



COURSE ADMINISTRATION

Welcome & Housekeeping

About the Trainer



Jim Gan Chiu Liang
(JL)

Principal Trainer
Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

ROLE

Principal Trainer, Tertiary Infotech Academy Pte. Ltd.

CERTIFICATION

Industry certified in the subject area of this course.

DELIVERS

Professional short courses for Tertiary Infotech Academy.

FOUNDER

Founder and lead instructor at Tertiary Infotech / Tertiary Courses.

Let's Know Each Other

1 Your name and organisation / role.

2 Your experience with this subject (if any).

3 What you want to be able to do after this course.

Ground Rules

1

Set your mobile phone to silent mode.

2

Participate actively — no question is too small.

3

Mutual respect: agree to disagree.

4

One conversation at a time.

5

Be punctual; return from breaks on time.

6

Learn by doing — try every hands-on lab.

Your Connected Course Workspace

1

Visual course deck

Concepts, process maps, prompt anatomy and realistic Office exhibits.

2

Detailed Learner Guide

Click-level procedures, full prompts, commands, checks and troubleshooting.

3

Eleven lab folders

A connected Lumina Living workflow with a README in every activity folder.

4

Native Office artifacts

Editable Word, Excel and PowerPoint samples plus reusable review templates.

Learner login: <https://www.tertiarycourses.com.sg/learnerlogin>

Lesson Plan — One Connected Company Day

Morning

- Morning · 9:30am–1:10pm
 - Topic 1: Getting Claude Ready for HR Work (Labs 0–3)
 - Topic 2: Hiring Plans, Policies and Staff Documents (Labs 4–5)

Afternoon

- Afternoon · 2:10pm–6:30pm
 - Topic 3: People Numbers and Reporting to Leadership (Labs 6–7)
 - Topic 4: Staff Questions, Repeatable Work and Advanced Claude (Labs 8–15)
- Daily timing
 - 8 scheduled hours excluding lunch · 7.5 instructional hours · two tea breaks

Learning Outcomes

1

Pick the right place

Choose the right place to use Claude for an HR task.

2

Decide what Claude reads

Decide what staff information Claude may read, and what it must never change.

3

Ask clearly

Write a request that says what you want, what to use, what to leave alone and when to stop.

4

Plan the hiring

Write a hiring plan in Word using only what the brief actually says.

5

Check the policy wording

Draft leave and flexible-work policy wording that flags every point needing legal review.

Learning Outcomes (cont.)

6

People numbers

Build a headcount and turnover analysis in Excel using live formulas.

7

Tell leadership

Build a leadership update deck where every slide title states a conclusion.

8

Handle the inbox

Sort the HR inbox and draft one reply ready for approval.

9

One folder, one summary

Have Claude read one folder and write a people summary that says where each fact came from.

10

Automate the update

Automate a weekly people update on your own computer.

Learning Outcomes (cont.)

11

Save it as a Skill

Save a working method as a Skill so the whole team applies the same standard.

12

Connect SharePoint

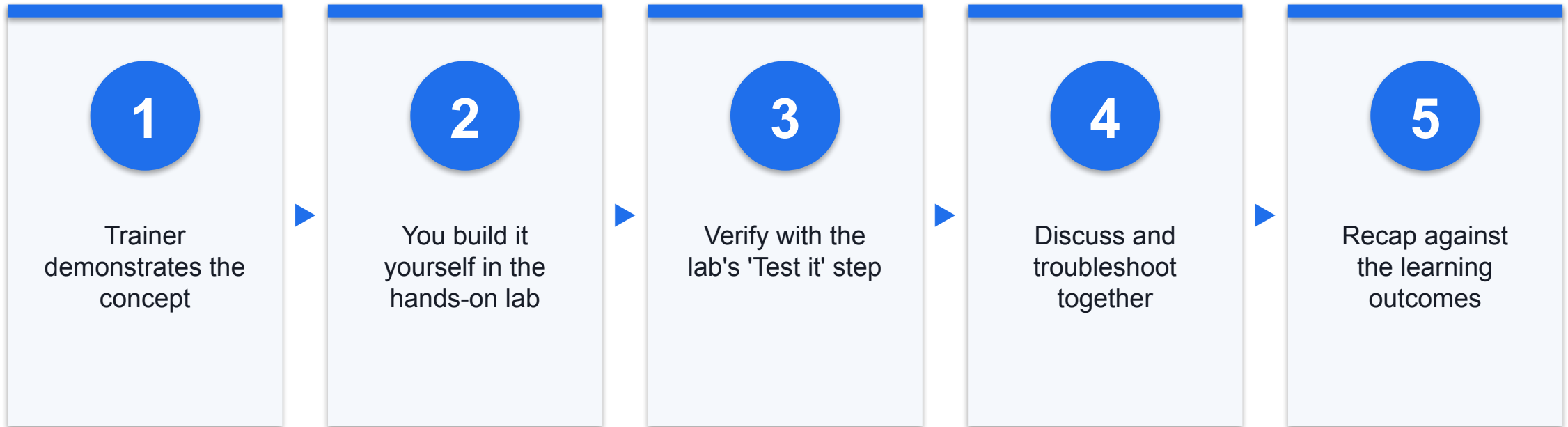
Use the Microsoft 365 connector to find HR files stored in SharePoint.

13

Add a plugin

Add a plugin, and judge when a task needs one and when it does not.

How You'll Learn





CORE CONCEPTS

The Lumina Living Management Challenge

One Company, One Connected Evidence Chain

1

Plan the year — turn the company's hiring needs into a plan, staff policies and clear approvals.

2

Work the numbers — check headcount, staff cost and budget assumptions in an Excel workbook you can follow.

3

Communicate the decision — build a company-standard executive deck using verified Word and Excel content.

4

Coordinate the work — triage Outlook, use Cowork for multi-file execution and use Claude Code for a repeatable daily brief.

The FRAME Control Loop

1

Frame

Name the decision, audience, permitted sources and definition of done.

2

Retrieve

Bring only authorised files, messages and ranges into context.

3

Act

Ask Claude to draft or edit the smallest useful unit in the native work product.

4

Measure

Verify figures, claims, formulas, formatting and policy constraints.

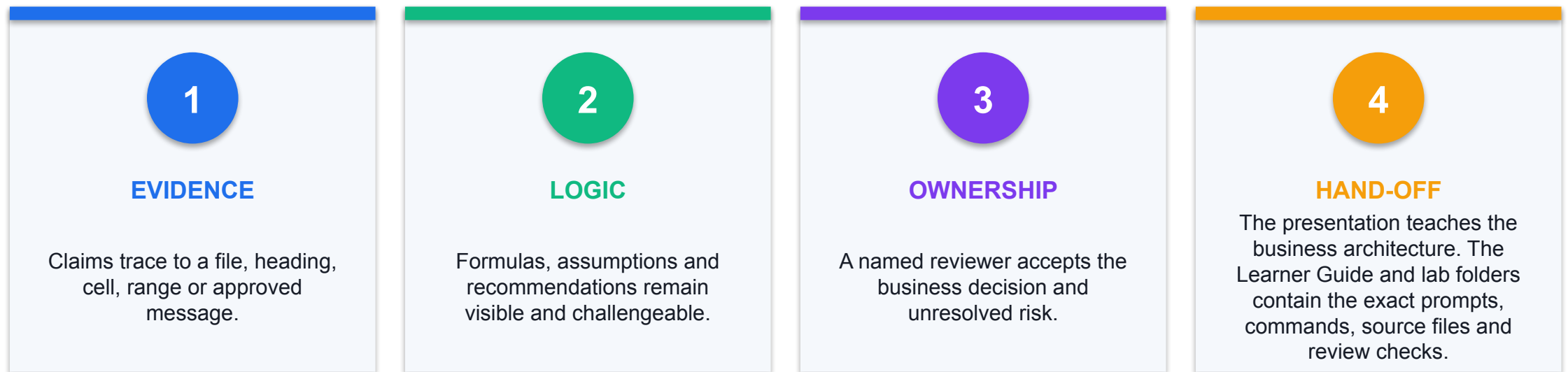
5

Endorse

Record assumptions and obtain the named human approval before save, send or release.

From Polished Output to Trusted Work

A polished output is not a trusted output until its evidence, logic and owner are visible.



The Company Pack You Will Build

Plans and policies

- Hiring plan
- One-page people plan
- Leave and flexible-work drafts

Analysis and story

- Headcount analysis
- People numbers
- Leadership update deck

Agentic coordination

- Outlook draft workflow
- Cowork project
- Claude Code daily brief

How Every Activity Connects

1

Open the lab folder and inspect its realistic Word, Excel and PowerPoint company artifacts.

2

Use the named evidence and prompt contract to create or improve a work product.

3

Challenge the result against formulas, sources, policy boundaries and company templates.

4

Record the approval, retain the verified artifact and pass only approved context to the next activity.



PROMPTING FOR OFFICE WORK

Prompts That Produce Reviewable Work

Word · Excel · PowerPoint · evidence · constraints · approval

The Five-Part Prompt Contract

1

Name the business result

State the decision, audience and artifact—not merely the app you are using.

2

Ground the work

Name the open file, table, sheet, section or approved message set Claude may use.

3

Constrain the edit

Define scope, length, style, formula method, layout and anything Claude must not change.

4

Demand evidence

Require cell, range, heading or email citations and ask Claude to flag missing information.

5

Set the approval gate

Ask for proposed changes first; verify them before accepting, saving, sending or publishing.

Claude-Generated Planning and Policy Samples

C197 · CLAUDE-GENERATED WORK SAMPLE

Create a Company Marketing Plan in Word

Lumina Living Pte Ltd · Illustrative reviewed output

Management outcome Which segments, channels and campaigns should receive the marketing budget?

Executive decision

Prioritise repeat customers and profitable digital growth while pausing broad discount-led acquisition.

Marketing choices

Focus owned channels, targeted lifecycle campaigns and higher-margin product stories.

Finding / choice	Evidence	Owner	Next review
Marketing choices item 1	FY2026 channel results	Marketing and E-commerce	Q1 FY2027
Marketing choices item 2	Customer segment note	Marketing and E-commerce	Q2 FY2027
Marketing choices item 3	Campaign calendar	Marketing and E-commerce	Q3 FY2027

90-day action

Launch two measured pilots with stop/go rules, accountable owners and a reconciled budget.

Source and approval note

Illustrative output generated for training from fictional Lumina Living sources. Figures and claims require source reconciliation. Release status: Pending named human approval.

LAB 04

FY2027 Hiring Plan

C197 · CLAUDE-GENERATED WORK SAMPLE

Develop a Strategic Plan with Owners and Measures

Lumina Living Pte Ltd · Illustrative reviewed output

Management outcome Which strategic choices and initiatives should the Executive Committee approve?

Strategic ambition

Build a profitable omnichannel growth engine with a differentiated home-lifestyle proposition.

Strategic choices

Win in curated ranges, integrate customer journeys and strengthen commercial execution.

Finding / choice	Evidence	Owner	Next review
Strategic choices item 1	CEO ambition note	Corporate Strategy	Q1 FY2027
Strategic choices item 2	Commercial performance summary	Corporate Strategy	Q2 FY2027
Strategic choices item 3	Operations capability review	Corporate Strategy	Q3 FY2027

Governance

Six initiatives report through a quarterly scorecard with explicit dependencies and risk owners.

Source and approval note

Illustrative output generated for training from fictional Lumina Living sources. Figures and claims require source reconciliation. Release status: Pending named human approval.

LAB 05

One-Page People Plan

C197 · CLAUDE-GENERATED WORK SAMPLE

Draft Sustainability Reporting and HR Policy

Lumina Living Pte Ltd · Illustrative reviewed output

Management outcome Is the evidence and control environment strong enough for internal release?

Reporting boundary

Singapore retail, office and directly controlled e-commerce operations for FY2026.

Sustainability performance

Energy and waste movements are reported with method notes and limitations; no unsupported green claim is made.

Flexible-work policy

Eligibility is role-based, decisions are documented and exceptions have a transparent review route.

Source and approval note

Illustrative output generated for training from fictional Lumina Living sources. Figures and claims require source reconciliation. Release status: Pending named human approval.

LAB 06

Leave and Flexible-Work Drafts

Claude-Generated Analysis and Executive Samples

LUMINA LIVING · FY2026 FINANCIAL DASHBOARD

REVENUE	GROSS PROFIT	GROSS MARGIN	OPERATING CONTRIBUTION
\$270,739	\$129,550	47.9%	-\$24,814

Monthly revenue: actual vs budget

Operating contribution by channel

Monthly budget variance

FINITIO

36% margin = Gross profit / Revenue
Operating contribution deducts fulfillment and marketing budget
Scenario assumptions remain separate from actuals
data is fictional training material
it refreshed: 12 Aug 2026

LAB 07

Headcount Analysis in Excel

MARKETING

Marketing allocation follows customer and margin evidence

Illustrative channel contribution

DECISION LOGIC

1 Protect profitable retail

2 Scale owned digital

3 Tighten marketplace economics

LAB 08

Leadership Update Deck

C197 · CLAUDE-GENERATED WORK SAMPLE

Triage and Prepare Approved Outlook Replies

Lumina Living Pte Ltd · Illustrative reviewed output

Management outcome Which messages need escalation, a standard draft, a tailored reply or no action?

Thread summary

The Executive Committee needs the reviewed pack, three owned actions and a confirmed review date.

Draft response

A concise reply confirms decisions and attachments and remains unsent until recipient and version checks are complete.

Meeting brief

Purpose, agenda, pre-read and one decision required are explicit.

Source and approval note

Illustrative output generated for training from fictional Lumina Living sources. Figures and claims require source reconciliation. Release status: Pending named human approval.

LAB 09

Sorted HR Inbox and Draft Reply

Inside the Claude-Generated Excel Dashboard

LUMINA LIVING · FY2026 FINANCIAL DASHBOARD

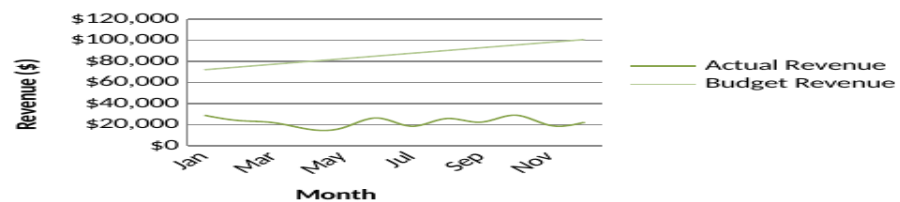
REVENUE
\$270,739

GROSS PROFIT
\$129,550

GROSS MARGIN
47.9%

OPERATING CONTRIBUTION
-\$24,814

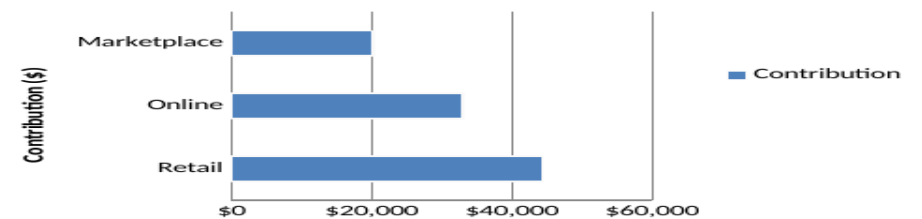
Monthly revenue: actual vs budget



Actual vs Plan

Shows whether headcount is on plan and where the gap appears each month.

Operating contribution by channel



Staff Cost by Team

Separates team size from team cost so leadership can act on the right one.

TOPIC 01

Getting Claude Ready for HR Work

Where to use Claude · what it may read · asking for what you want

Key Concepts — Getting Claude Ready for HR Work

1

Three places to use Claude — inside Word, Excel and PowerPoint; in the Claude Desktop app; and in the browser. Each one sees different things.

2

The panel inside Office works on the file you already have open, and keeps your headings, formulas and slide layouts.

3

The Claude Desktop app can read a whole folder at once, so use it when the answer spans several files.

4

HR files hold information about real people. Decide what Claude may read, and what it must never change, before you start.

5

Ask Claude to say where each fact came from — which file, which sheet, which line — so you can check it before it reaches a staff member.

6

You decide, not Claude. Nothing is sent, published or approved until a named person says yes.

Hands-On Labs — Getting Claude Ready for HR Work

Labs 0–1

- Set Up Claude for Microsoft 365 — A completed setup checklist showing which of the four routes are ready, and what to do about any that are not.
- Shortlist Candidates with AI Experience — A saved shortlist in your own workbook, a second copy saved from the Desktop app, and one sentence on which way suits work that must stay in one file.

Labs 2–3

- Analyse Staff Data and Decide What Claude May Read — A summary table and chart built by Claude in your own workbook, plus a completed access table.
- Ask Claude Clearly — A new section written into the brief by Claude, a second copy produced by the Desktop app, and a completed request checklist.

Set Up Claude for Microsoft 365

LAB 0

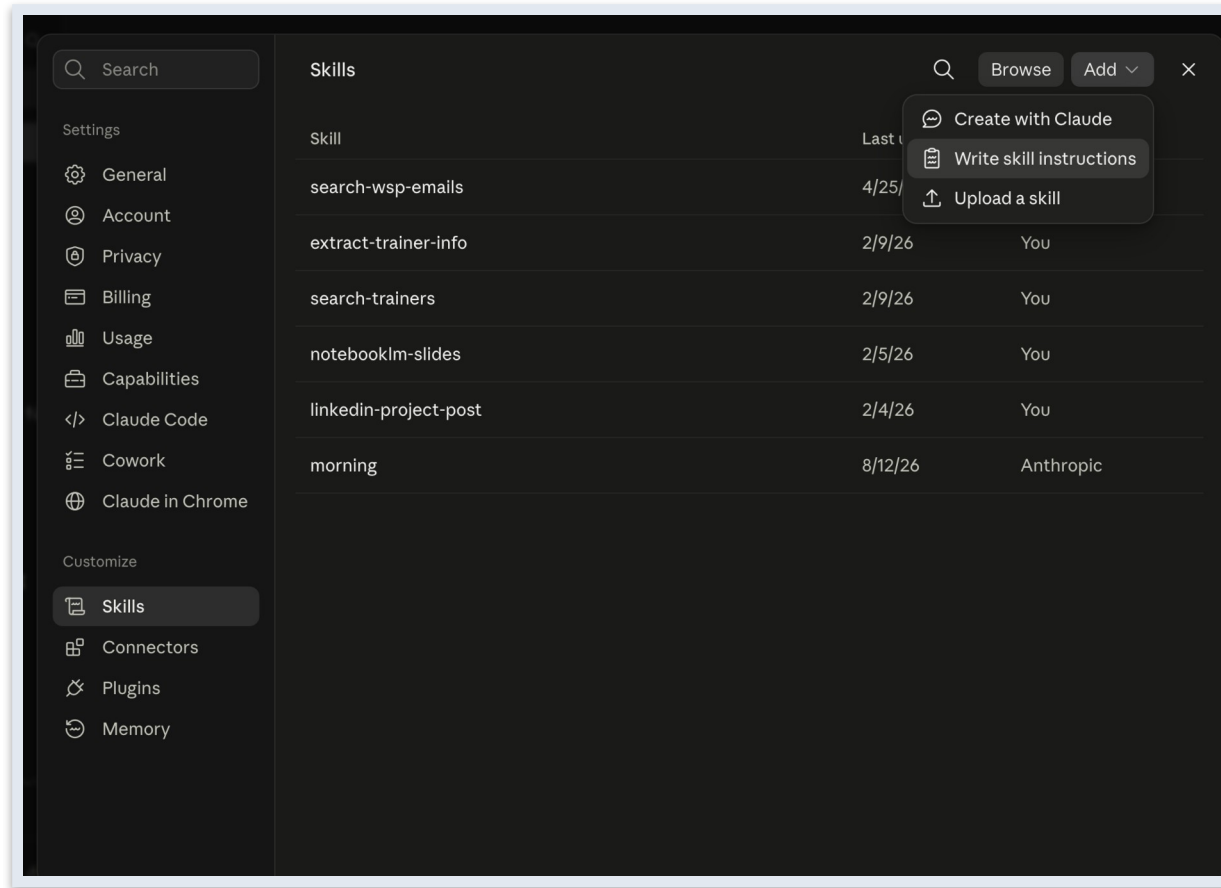
Install the Claude add-in in Word, Excel and PowerPoint, sign in to Claude Desktop, connect the Microsoft 365 connector, and add Claude for Chrome. Record what works on your machine before the labs begin.

You'll build

A completed setup checklist showing which of the four routes are ready, and what to do about any that are not.

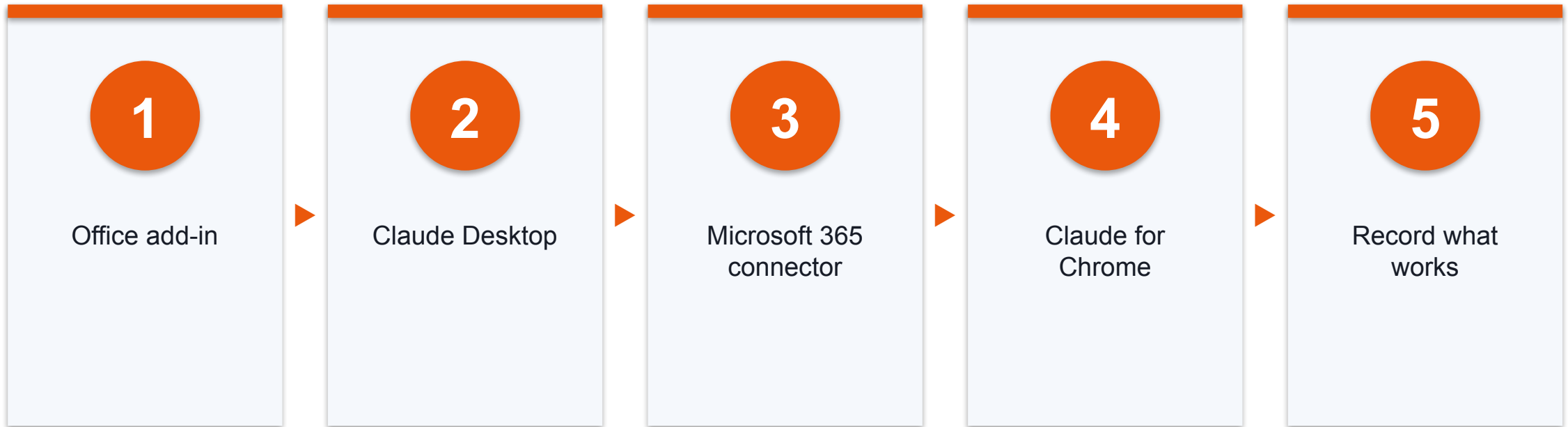
Tools: Claude for Microsoft 365 add-in, Claude Desktop, Microsoft 365 connector, Claude for Chrome

Where Skills Live



Settings > Skills on claude.ai. Add offers three ways to make one: Create with Claude, Write skill instructions, or Upload a skill.

Lab 0 — Process Map



Lab 0 — Professional Practice

1

Four ways in

The Office panel, the Desktop app, the Microsoft 365 connector and the Chrome extension each see different things.

2

Install once

The add-in appears in Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook once it is added.

3

The connector needs approval

It reads your Microsoft 365 content, so an administrator must enable it first.

4

Not available is a valid answer

Record what your account actually allows; the labs tell you the local alternative.

Set Up Claude for Microsoft 365

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

Every row of the Setup tab has a result. The Claude panel opens in Word, Excel and PowerPoint. Claude Desktop is signed in. The Microsoft 365 connector is either connected or recorded as Needs IT approval. Claude for Chrome is installed and set to Manually approve, or recorded as unavailable.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Shortlist Candidates with AI Experience

LAB 1

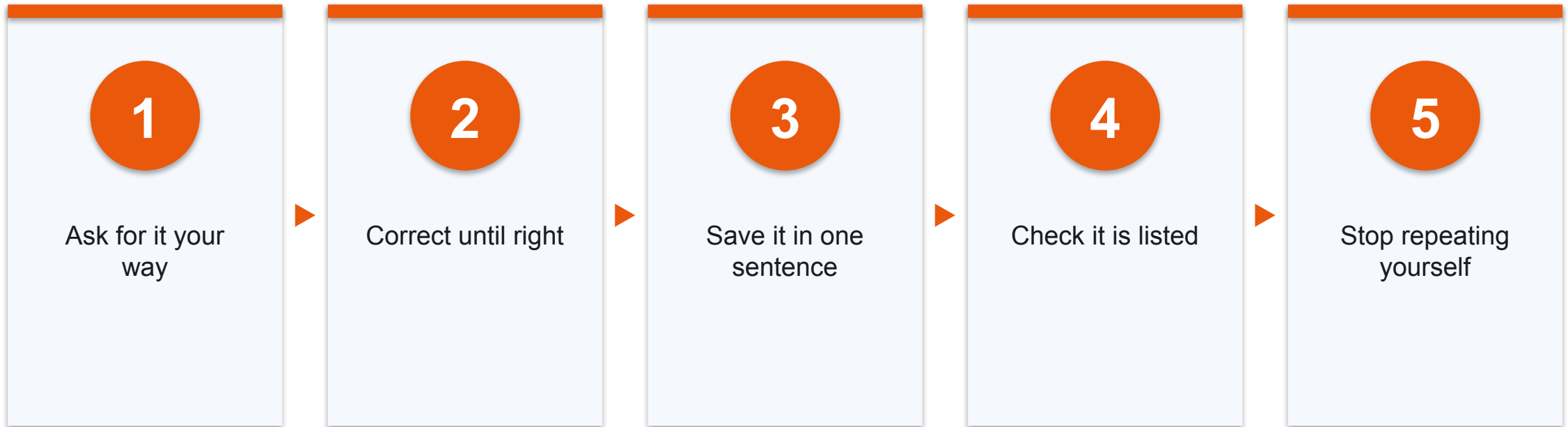
Twenty-four people applied for HR roles. Claude fills in the shortlist directly in your Excel sheet, you check its decisions, then you run the same request in the Claude Desktop app and see that it hands you a downloaded copy instead of editing your file.

You'll build

A saved shortlist in your own workbook, a second copy saved from the Desktop app, and one sentence on which way suits work that must stay in one file.

Tools: Claude for Word, Claude Skills, natural-language skill creation

Lab 1 — Process Map



Lab 1 — What You Teach

1

Spell it out once

The first time, say exactly how you want the work done.

2

Every correction is a rule

What you fix now, you never have to say again.

3

Saving is a sentence

'Save that as a skill called hr-draft.' No menu, no form.

4

Policy needs care

Never let Claude state a legal conclusion on your behalf.

Shortlist Candidates with AI Experience

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

All 24 rows have Yes or No with a quoted reason and the file is saved, rows C-011 and C-013 are marked No, a second file named Lumina-Living-Lab-01-Candidates-Desktop.xlsx exists in the folder, and you have written which of the two ways keeps the shortlist in one agreed file.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Analyse Staff Data and Decide What Claude May Read

LAB 2

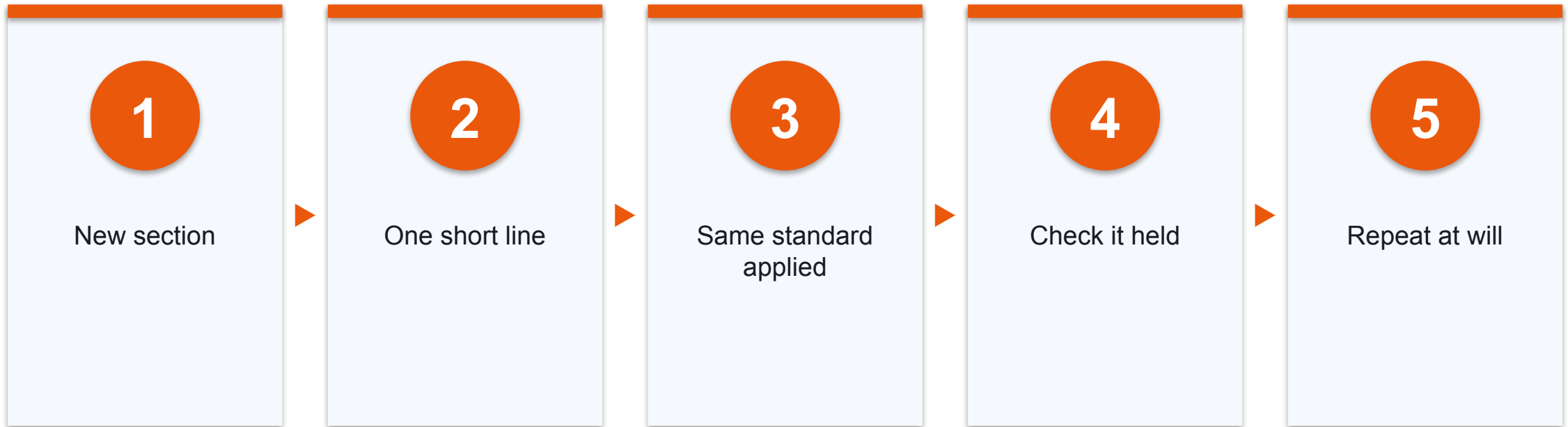
Claude summarises the staff list by team, builds a chart, and you check its formulas. Then you decide what access Claude actually needed, having just seen what read-only access can do.

You'll build

A summary table and chart built by Claude in your own workbook, plus a completed access table.

Tools: Claude for Word, Claude Skills

Lab 2 — Process Map



Lab 2 — Professional Practice

1

One line is enough

The rules live in the skill, not in what you type.

2

The standard holds

Quality stops depending on remembering.

3

You still own it

A skill drafts; you check and you approve.

4

Compare the results

Three sections, one standard, no repetition.

Analyse Staff Data and Decide What Claude May Read

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

The summary table uses formulas that point at the staff rows, the chart shows leaver rate by team, the file is saved, and all four places have a read-or-change decision with an owner.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Ask Claude Clearly

LAB 3

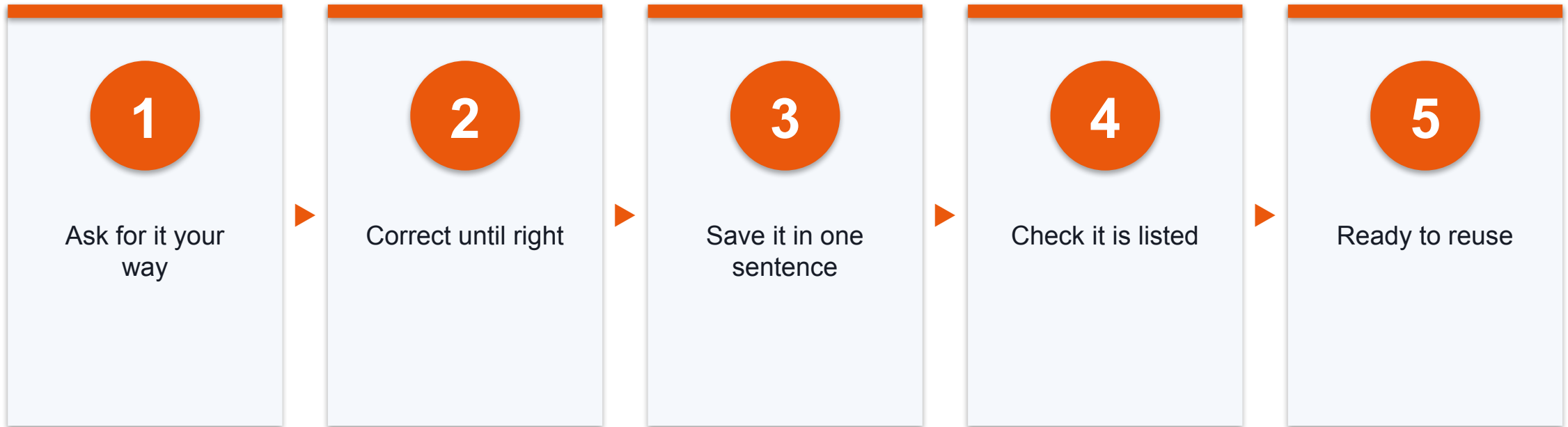
Run a vague request and a clear one against the same HR brief, and see the difference for yourself.

You'll build

A new section written into the brief by Claude, a second copy produced by the Desktop app, and a completed request checklist.

Tools: Claude for Excel, Claude Skills, natural-language skill creation

Lab 3 — Process Map



Lab 3 — Professional Practice

1

Spell it out once

The first time, say exactly how the numbers should be worked out.

2

Formulas, never typed-in numbers

The rule that keeps the analysis checkable.

3

Saving is a sentence

'Save that as a skill called staff-numbers.'

4

Works beyond this file

Say so when you save, and the skill can read other workbooks too.

Ask Claude Clearly

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

The new section sits after '3. Required management outputs' with every fact naming its heading, the file is saved, a second file named Lumina-Living-Lab-03-HR-Brief-Desktop.docx exists, and the checklist says which document you would send on and why.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Recap — Getting Claude Ready for HR Work

1

Capability — Install and check every way you will use Claude on this course, and record what your own account allows.

2

Evidence retained — A completed setup checklist showing which of the four routes are ready, and what to do about any that are not.

3

Capability — Use Claude to shortlist job applicants, and see the difference between the Excel panel and the Claude Desktop app.

4

Evidence retained — A saved shortlist in your own workbook, a second copy saved from the Desktop app, and one sentence on which way suits work that must stay in one file.

5

Capability — Use Claude to summarise and chart real staff data, then decide what access it needed to do that.

6

Evidence retained — A summary table and chart built by Claude in your own workbook, plus a completed access table.

TOPIC 02

Hiring Plans, Policies and Staff Documents

Hiring plan · leave and flexible-work policy · handbook wording · who signs off

Key Concepts — Hiring Plans, Policies and Staff Documents

1

A hiring plan makes choices: which roles now, which can wait, and what the budget will not cover.

2

Every role needs a hiring manager, a start date, a salary range and the reason the role exists.

3

Policy wording carries real consequences. Anything about pay, leave, notice or conduct needs proper review before release.

4

Keep three things apart: what the policy says, how it works day to day, and what needs legal advice.

5

Work inside the company template so the document looks like every other HR document staff receive.

6

Say plainly what you do not yet know, rather than filling the gap with a confident guess.

WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — Hiring Plans, Policies and Staff Documents

Lab 4

- Write a Hiring Plan in Word — A hiring plan section written into the brief, and a separate Lumina-Living-FY2027-Hiring-Plan.docx ready for the Head of HR.

Lab 5

- Build an HR Policy Skill from Your Real Policies — An hr-policy-draft skill built from your real policy library and template, and two new policies on the company letterhead.

Write a Hiring Plan in Word

LAB 4

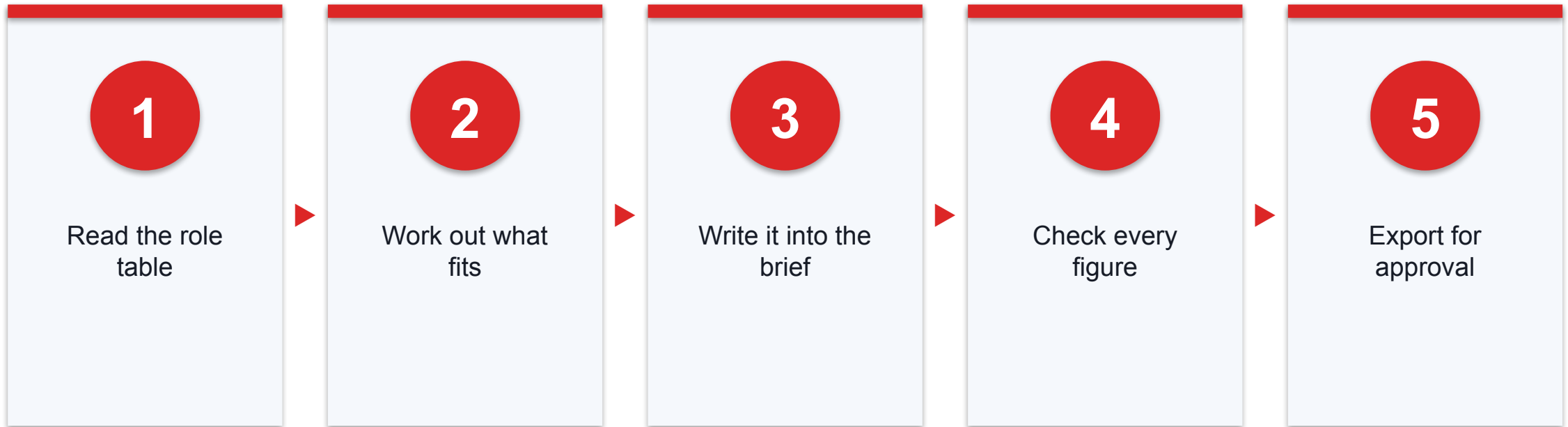
Section 2 of the brief lists five roles the teams want and the budget that limits them. Claude works out what fits, writes the plan into your document, then exports it as a standalone document for approval.

You'll build

A hiring plan section written into the brief, and a separate Lumina-Living-FY2027-Hiring-Plan.docx ready for the Head of HR.

Tools: Claude for Word, company templates, evidence checks, human approval

Lab 4 — Process Map



Lab 4 — Professional Practice

1

The budget is the constraint

Not every requested role can be filled; the plan must say which and why.

2

Every figure has a source

Salary bands come from the table, never from memory.

3

Propose before you write

Check the arithmetic in the panel before it touches the document.

4

Two documents, two jobs

The brief keeps the evidence; the exported plan goes for approval.

Write a Hiring Plan in Word

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

The brief has an 'FY2027 hiring plan' section after section 3 with every salary matching the table in section 2, the total is shown against the \$38,000 budget and the 10-role cap, and a separate file named Lumina-Living-FY2027-Hiring-Plan.docx exists in the folder containing only the plan.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Build an HR Policy Skill from Your Real Policies

LAB 5

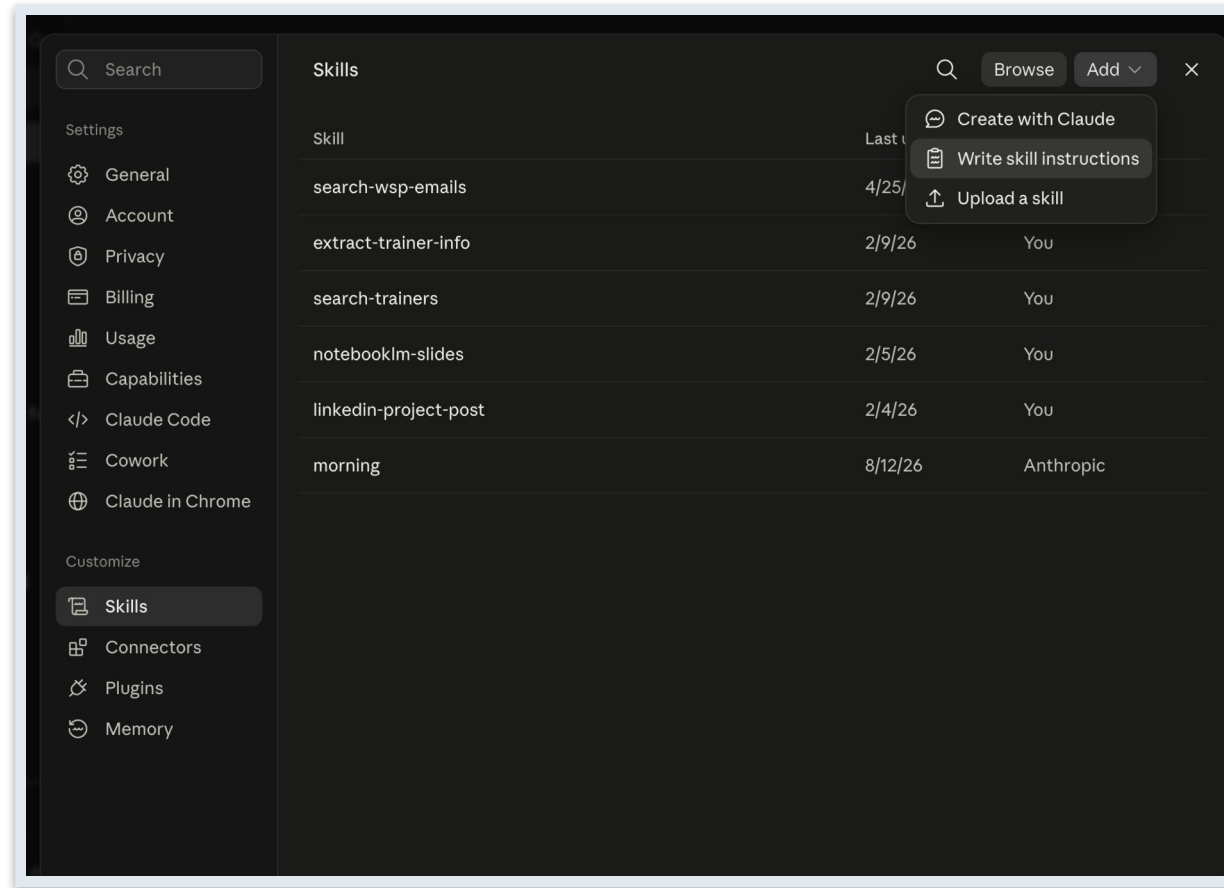
Your house style already exists in the policies you have published and the template you write them into. Hand Claude the examples, the rules and the template, turn that into a skill, then draft two new policies from a real consultation note.

You'll build

An hr-policy-draft skill built from your real policy library and template, and two new policies on the company letterhead.

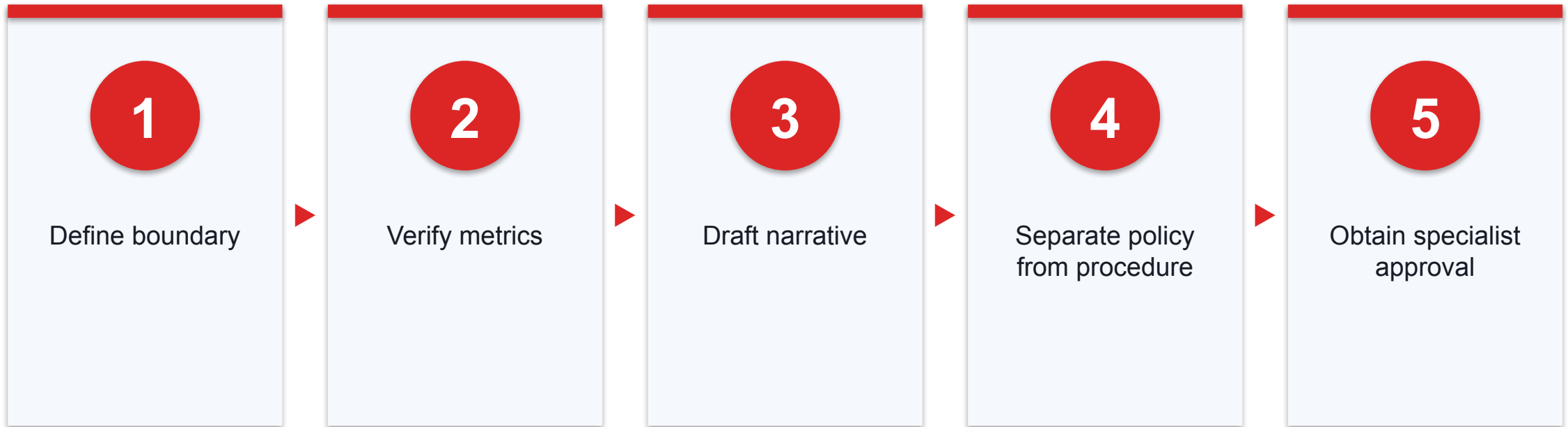
Tools: Claude Skills, Upload a skill, Claude for Word

Creating the HR Policy Skill



Settings > Skills > Add. Lab 5 uses Create with Claude, handing it the policy library and the written standard.

Lab 5 — Process Map



Lab 5 — Professional Practice

1

Boundary before narrative

State entities, sites, period, method and exclusions before describing performance.

2

Numbers need lineage

Every metric names the source system, owner, unit, method and limitation.

3

Policy is not legal advice

AI drafts require authorised HR and legal review before organisational release.

4

Exceptions are designed

Eligibility, decision rights, escalation and record keeping prevent an attractive policy from becoming unusable.

Build an HR Policy Skill from Your Real Policies

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

A skill named hr-policy-draft is listed in Settings > Skills, both new policies use the company letterhead and the four numbered sections, every fact traces to the consultation note, every open point from the note appears under 'Still to confirm', no legal conclusion is stated, the approval table is intact, and both files are saved in the lab folder.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Recap — Hiring Plans, Policies and Staff Documents

1

Capability — Write an FY2027 hiring plan in Word using only what the HR brief actually says.

2

Evidence retained — A hiring plan section written into the brief, and a separate Lumina-Living-FY2027-Hiring-Plan.docx ready for the Head of HR.

3

Capability — Create a skill from your company's existing policy documents, then use it to draft new policy wording that matches them.

4

Evidence retained — An hr-policy-draft skill built from your real policy library and template, and two new policies on the company letterhead.

TOPIC 03

People Numbers and Reporting to Leadership

Headcount and turnover in Excel · what the numbers say · the leadership update

Key Concepts — People Numbers and Reporting to Leadership

1

Keep the staff data, the assumptions and the results on separate sheets so anyone can follow the working.

2

Use live formulas that point at the source data. A number typed in by hand cannot be checked or updated.

3

Compare actual headcount and cost against plan, month by month and team by team, before you explain the result.

4

Pick the chart that answers the question leadership asked. More charts is not more insight.

5

Every slide title should say what you concluded, not name a topic.

6

Put the source under any figure on a slide, so the room can challenge it.

WHAT YOU'LL DO

Hands-On Labs — People Numbers and Reporting to Leadership

Lab 6

- Build a Headcount Analysis in Excel — An analysis sheet where every result is a formula that points back to the source data.

Lab 7

- Build a Leadership Deck Two Ways — Two versions of the same six-slide update: one built in the panel with a linked Excel chart, one built end to end by Claude Desktop.

Build a Headcount Analysis in Excel

LAB 6

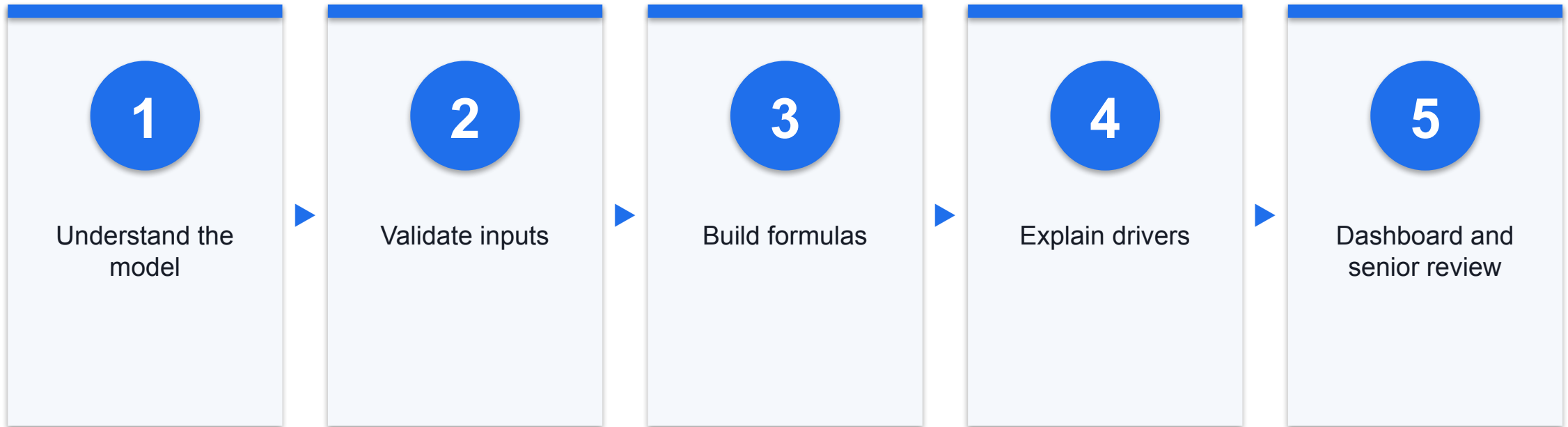
Compare actual headcount and staff cost against plan, month by month and team by team, using formulas that point at the source data.

You'll build

An analysis sheet where every result is a formula that points back to the source data.

Tools: Claude for Excel, tables, formulas, pivots, scenarios, chart selection, dashboard, audit log

Lab 6 — Process Map



Lab 6 — Professional Practice

1

Model architecture

Separate Assumptions, Transactions, Budget, Analysis, Dashboard and Audit Log.

2

No pasted answers

Keep calculations live in formulas or pivots and cite the source range.

3

Charts answer decisions

Use trend, variance and driver visuals with honest scales and units.

4

Review like a finance leader

Challenge timing, hardcodes, range gaps, margin logic and scenario sensitivity.

Build a Headcount Analysis in Excel

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

Two result cells checked in the formula bar show real formulas pointing at the source data, and changing an assumption updates the analysis.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Build a Leadership Deck Two Ways

LAB 7

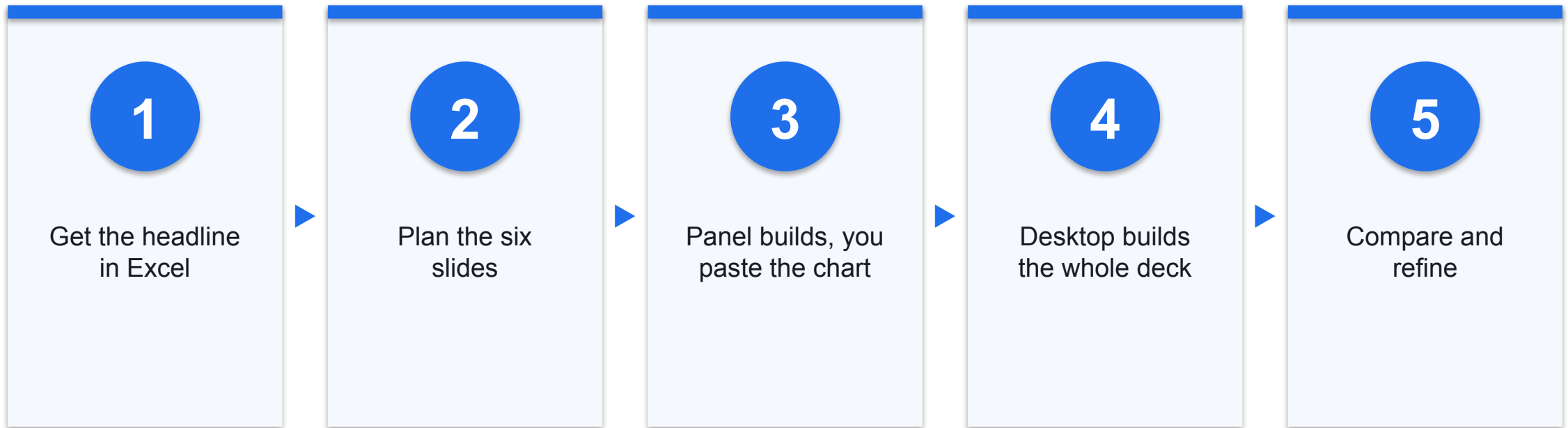
Start from a blank deck. Build it with the Office panel, pasting the chart yourself so it stays linked to Excel. Then have Claude Desktop build the whole thing unaided, and compare what each produced.

You'll build

Two versions of the same six-slide update: one built in the panel with a linked Excel chart, one built end to end by Claude Desktop.

Tools: Claude for PowerPoint, Claude for Excel, Claude Desktop, linked native charts

Lab 7 — Process Map



Lab 7 — Professional Practice

1

Panel: one file at a time

It edits the deck you have open, so you paste the chart yourself — and it stays linked.

2

Desktop: reads the folder

It sees Excel and Word together and produces a finished file, but not into your open deck.

3

Linked beats pasted picture

A linked chart updates when the numbers change; a picture does not.

4

Keep prompting

Neither method is one-shot. Split a slide, sharpen a title, add a closing ask.

Build a Leadership Deck Two Ways

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

Both decks exist: one built in the panel with the Excel chart pasted in and linked, one named Lumina-Living-Q1-Update-Desktop.pptx built by Claude Desktop. Every title states a conclusion, every figure has a source note, you have written which version keeps the chart linked to the workbook, and at least one refinement prompt was used after the first build.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Recap — People Numbers and Reporting to Leadership

1

Capability — Build a headcount and cost analysis in Excel using live formulas, not typed-in numbers.

2

Evidence retained — An analysis sheet where every result is a formula that points back to the source data.

3

Capability — Build the same deck twice — once with the PowerPoint panel and a pasted Excel chart, once with Claude Desktop reading both files — and judge which suits the job.

4

Evidence retained — Two versions of the same six-slide update: one built in the panel with a linked Excel chart, one built end to end by Claude Desktop.

TOPIC 04

Staff Questions, Repeatable Work and Advanced Claude

Sorting the HR inbox · one folder, one summary · the weekly update · Skills, connectors and plugins

Key Concepts — Staff Questions, Repeatable Work and Advanced Claude

1

Sort staff messages by what each one needs: a reply from you, a decision from someone else, or nothing at all.

2

Claude drafts the reply; you check the facts, the tone and the recipient, and you are the one who sends it.

3

Point Claude Desktop at one folder and it can pull a summary together from everything inside it.

4

When two files disagree, that disagreement is the finding. It is not Claude's job to settle it quietly.

5

Work you repeat every week is worth automating once, with a backup taken before anything is overwritten.

6

An automated update still needs a person to read it before it goes to anyone else.

Hands-On Labs — Staff Questions, Repeatable Work and Advanced Claude

Labs 8–9, 15

- Use the Skill from Word Without Opening Excel — A completed quarterly update with figures drawn from the workbook, saved as a final copy.
- Sort the HR Inbox and Draft One Reply — Every message sorted, one reply drafted, the person who would approve it named, and the reply created as an Outlook draft ready for review.
- Read a Whole Folder and Write the Summary — A two-page people summary built only from the folder, naming the file behind every claim, with disagreements reported rather than settled.

Labs 10–12

- Build a Daily HR Routine with Cowork — A written daily routine covering inbox, reporting and chasing; this week's work assigned an owner and a deadline; and today's daily HR report.
- Automate an HR Pipeline with a Project — A Lumina Living HR project with materials and standing instructions, and a new starter pipeline run twice from it.
- Draft an Outlook Reply with Claude in Chrome — A reviewed reply drafted in Outlook on the web, sent only after you approved it or deliberately left in Drafts.

Labs 13–14

- Add Skills and Connectors to the Project — An HR project with materials, standing rules, a skill and a connector, running one request that produces a policy draft, a summary and an Outlook draft.
- Upload a Shared Skill for Slides — An uploaded deck-design-standard skill, and a rebuilt deck where every title states a conclusion.

Use the Skill from Word Without Opening Excel

LAB 15

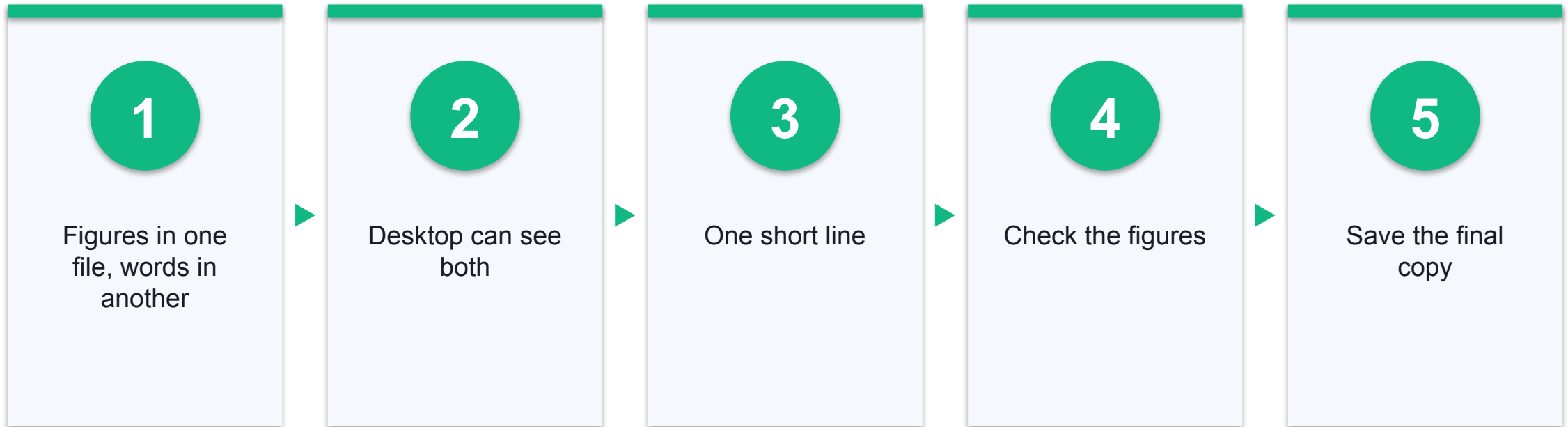
The quarterly update is due and the figures are in a workbook. One short line, and the skill reads the workbook, works the numbers out your way, and writes them into the update.

You'll build

A completed quarterly update with figures drawn from the workbook, saved as a final copy.

Tools: Claude Skills, Claude Desktop, Word, Excel

Lab 15 — Process Map



Lab 15 — Professional Practice

1

Across two apps

The skill reads Excel and writes Word without you switching.

2

Panel versus Desktop

The Office panel sees one open file; Desktop sees the folder.

3

One line is enough

Every rule lives in the skill, not in what you type.

4

Desktop hands you a copy

It does not edit your open file — save the copy deliberately.

Use the Skill from Word Without Opening Excel

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

The update contains totals by team and the leaver rate to one decimal place, the worst team is named and explained, two figures were checked against the workbook by hand, and a file named Lumina-Living-Q1-Update-Final.docx exists in the folder.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Sort the HR Inbox and Draft One Reply

LAB 8

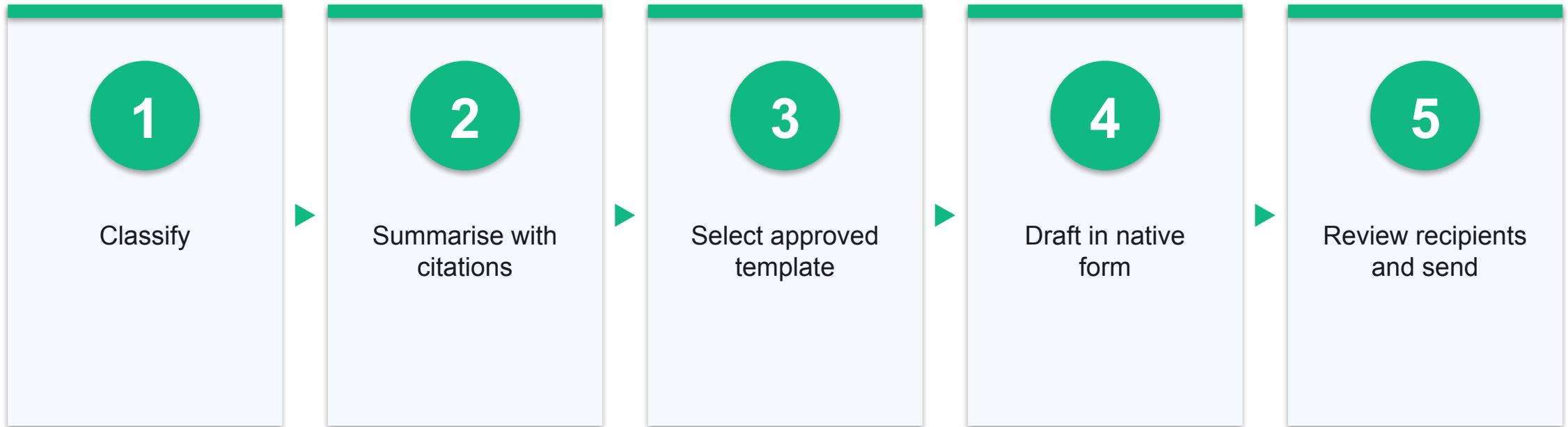
Work through a set of fictional staff messages held in a local workbook. Claude sorts them by what each one needs and drafts one reply. Then the Microsoft 365 connector turns that reply into a real Outlook draft — which you review and send yourself.

You'll build

Every message sorted, one reply drafted, the person who would approve it named, and the reply created as an Outlook draft ready for review.

Tools: Claude for Outlook beta, Outlook categories, thread citations, reply templates, calendar, approval queue

Lab 8 — Process Map



Lab 8 — Professional Practice

1

Rules before generation

Define category, priority, SLA, reply eligibility and escalation before asking Claude to draft.

2

Thread evidence

Capture decisions, owners and deadlines with citations to the specific message.

3

Auto-draft, not auto-send

Claude for Outlook leaves drafts and invitations in Outlook for the authorised user.

4

Consequential details

Recipients, attachments, dates, amounts and promises receive explicit human checks.

Sort the HR Inbox and Draft One Reply

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

Every message has an answer in the Action column, one reply under 120 words is written in the Draft_Reply column, its approver is named, and the reply exists as an unsent draft in Outlook or the connector state is recorded. Nothing was sent.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Read a Whole Folder and Write the Summary

LAB 9

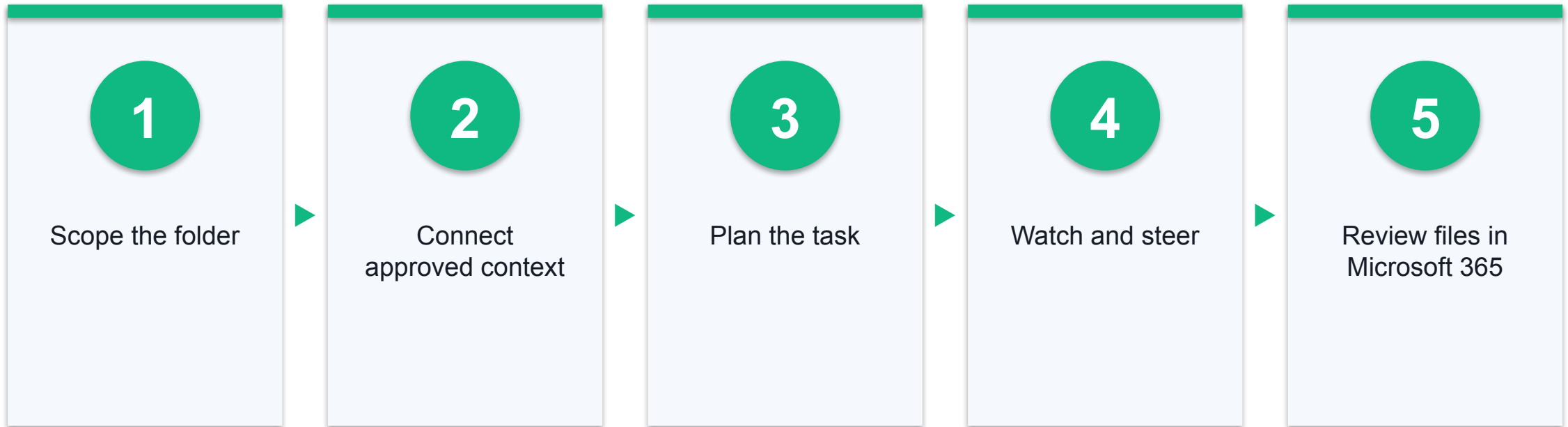
A quarter's worth of HR reports sits in one folder as PDFs, with a CSV of the numbers. No single file answers the question. Claude reads them all and writes one summary, naming the file behind every claim.

You'll build

A two-page people summary built only from the folder, naming the file behind every claim, with disagreements reported rather than settled.

Tools: Claude Cowork, work folder, Projects, plugins, Microsoft 365 connector, multi-step execution, approvals

Lab 9 — Process Map



Lab 9 — Professional Practice

1

Bounded workspace

Give Cowork one project folder or Project, not uncontrolled access to unrelated files.

2

Connector supplies context

Search approved SharePoint, OneDrive, Outlook and Teams evidence through delegated permissions.

3

Cowork executes over steps

It can inspect inputs, create real files, update the plan and surface checkpoints.

4

Office add-ins finish the work

Open generated Word, Excel and PowerPoint files in the native apps for tracked review and approval.

Read a Whole Folder and Write the Summary

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

The summary covers headcount against plan, why people are leaving and the hiring pipeline; every claim names its file; the disagreement between the headcount report and the CSV is reported with both figures; two figures were checked by hand; and the closing note says what still needs the Head of HR to confirm.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Build a Daily HR Routine with Cowork

LAB 11

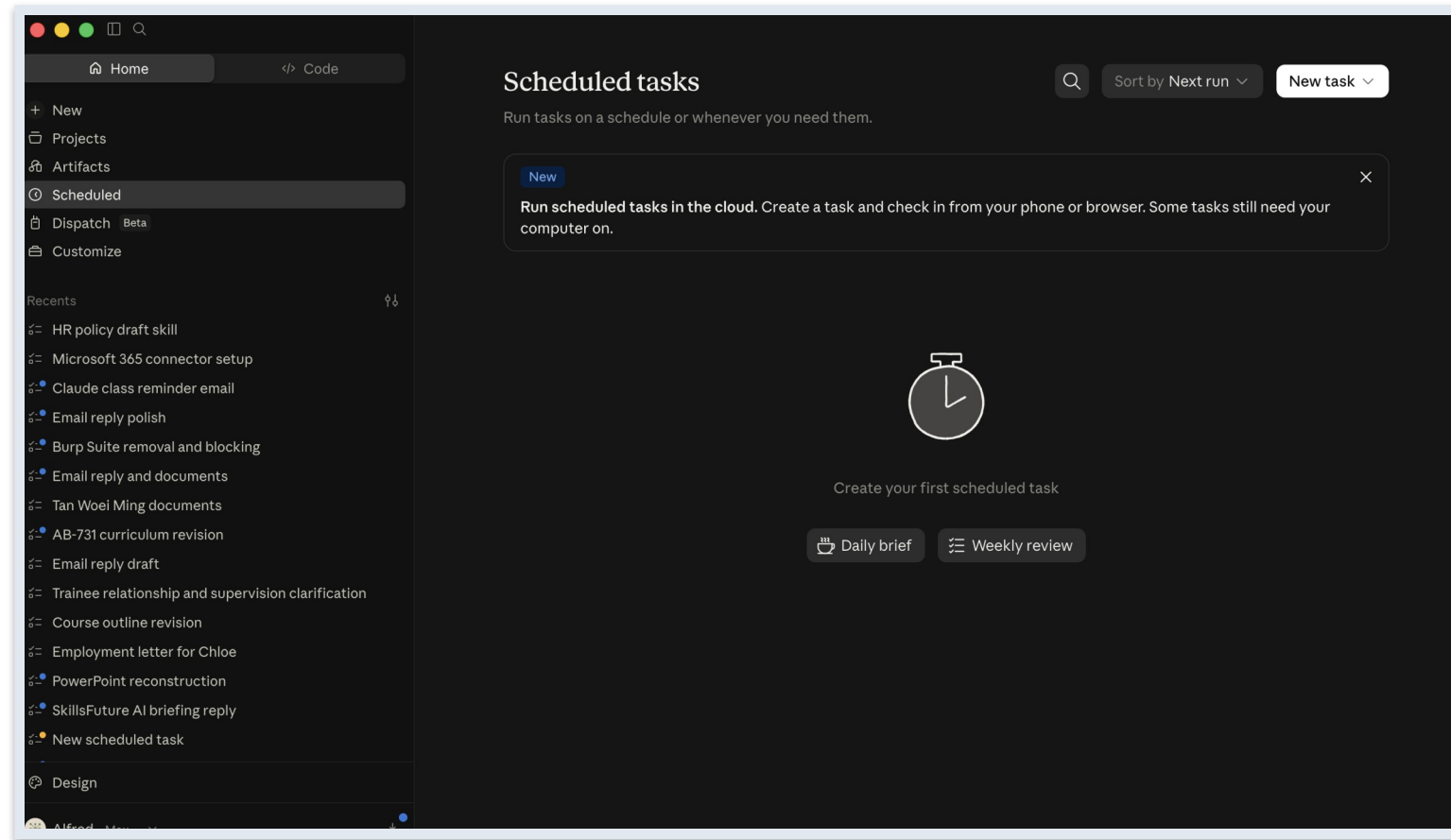
Ten things landed on the HR desk this week. Cowork finds what actually repeats, writes a daily routine, applies it back to the week, and produces the Monday brief. No terminal, no scripts.

You'll build

A written daily routine covering inbox, reporting and chasing; this week's work assigned an owner and a deadline; and today's daily HR report.

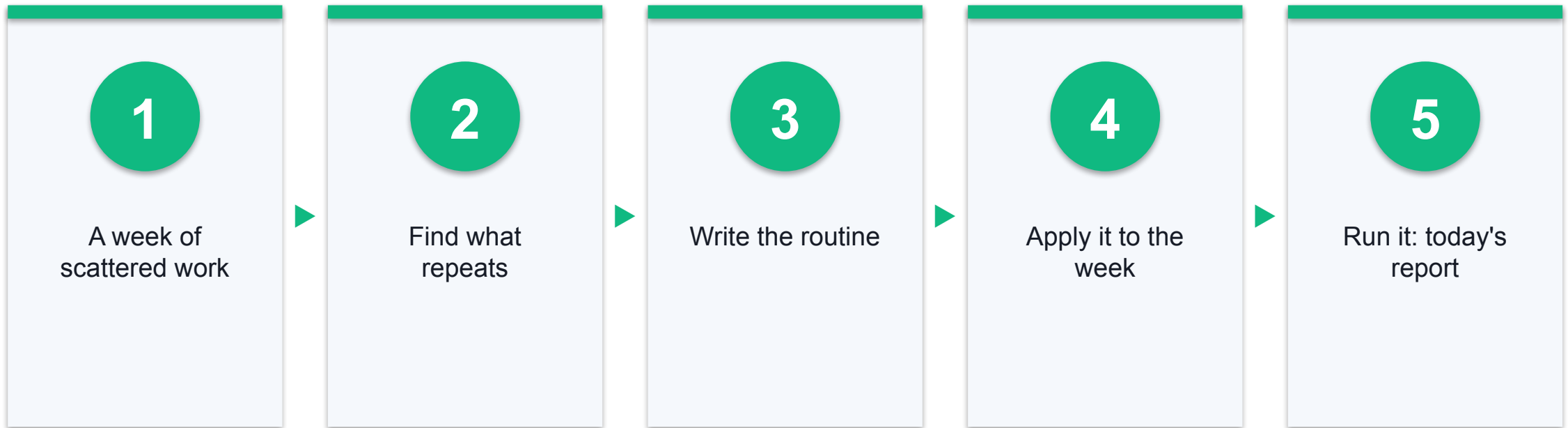
Tools: Claude Cowork, Claude Desktop, Excel, Word

Scheduled Tasks



Claude Desktop > Scheduled. Daily brief and Weekly review are ready-made task types; New task builds your own. Delete a task when the class ends.

Lab 11 — Process Map



Lab 11 — Professional Practice

1

Cowork works across files

Give it a folder and it moves between the workbook and the documents on its own.

2

Routine beats memory

Work that repeats every week should not depend on someone remembering it.

3

Gaps are findings

If the routine cannot place a task, that is a hole in the routine, not a mistake to paper over.

4

A person still reads it

The brief goes nowhere until the Head of HR has seen it.

Build a Daily HR Routine with Cowork

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

The Daily_Routine sheet covers checking the inbox, the daily report and chasing overdue items, each with when, what, where and who. Every row of This_Week has an action, an owner and a deadline, or is marked as not covered. Lumina-Living-Daily-HR-Report.docx exists, fits one page, and names the row behind every item.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Automate an HR Pipeline with a Project

LAB 12

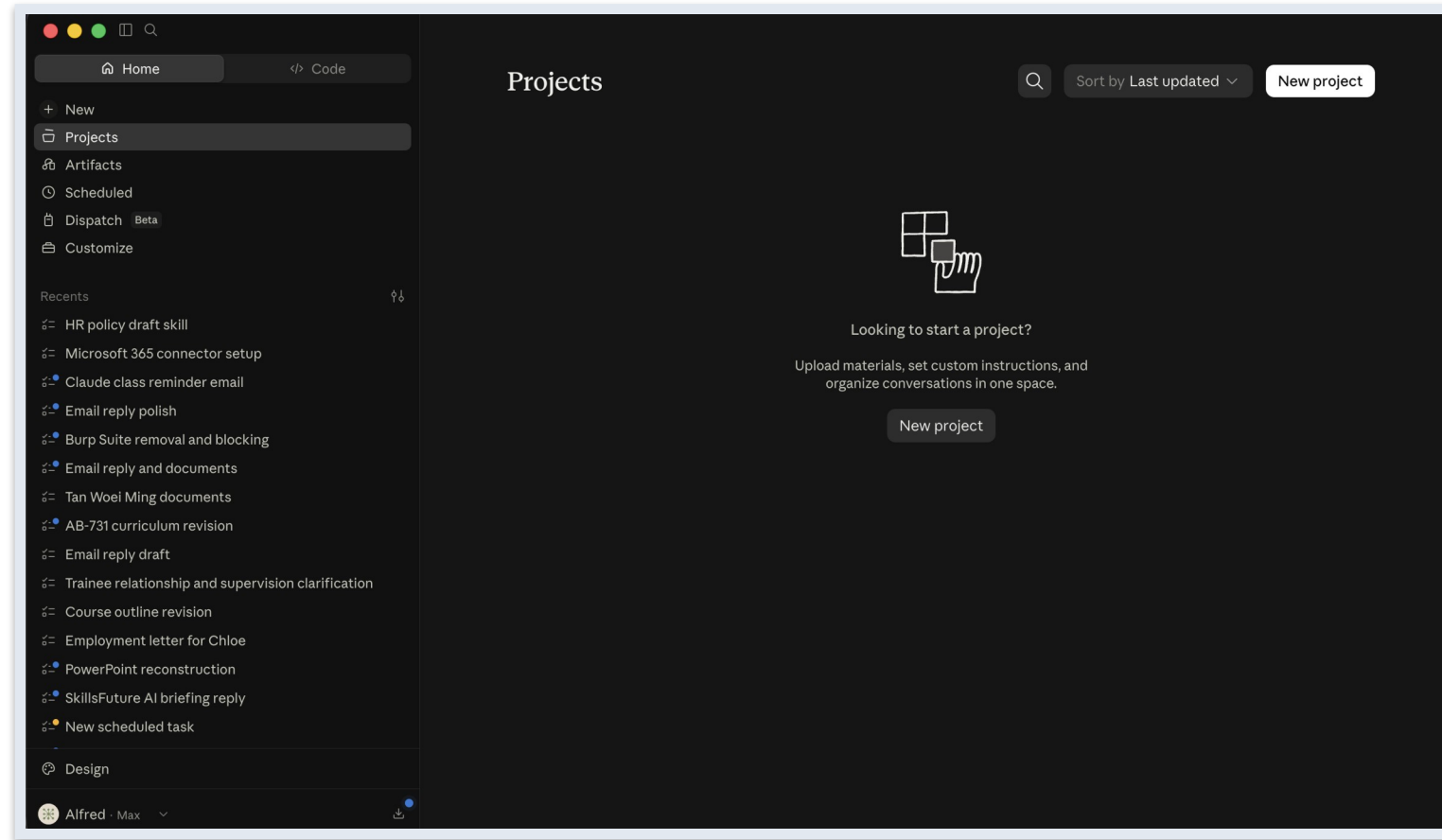
A project keeps the policy library, the staff data and the house rules in one workspace. Set it up once, then run the new starter pipeline twice without attaching a file or restating a rule.

You'll build

A Lumina Living HR project with materials and standing instructions, and a new starter pipeline run twice from it.

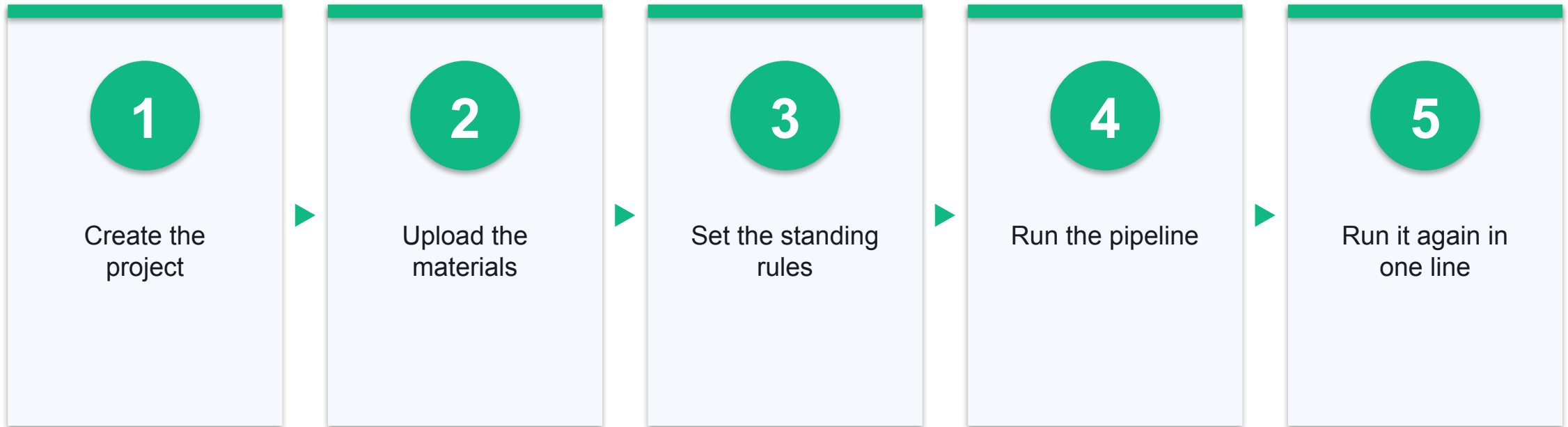
Tools: Claude Projects, Claude Desktop, project instructions, uploaded materials

Projects



Claude Desktop > Projects > New project. Upload the HR materials once and set standing instructions, so every conversation in the project starts with the same context.

Lab 12 — Process Map



Lab 12 — Professional Practice

1

A project holds context

Materials and instructions live in the workspace, not in each prompt.

2

Skills carry the how

A skill is a method; a project is the material that method works on.

3

Set the rules once

The standing instructions apply to every conversation in the project.

4

Repeatable, not automatic

The pipeline repeats itself; a person still reads what comes out.

Automate an HR Pipeline with a Project

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

A project named Lumina Living HR exists with the policy PDFs, the staff workbook and the quarter files uploaded, and custom instructions set. The new starter pipeline produced a checklist with owners, a welcome note and a report line for two different starters, every fact naming its source file, with gaps marked 'need to check'.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Draft an Outlook Reply with Claude in Chrome

LAB 10

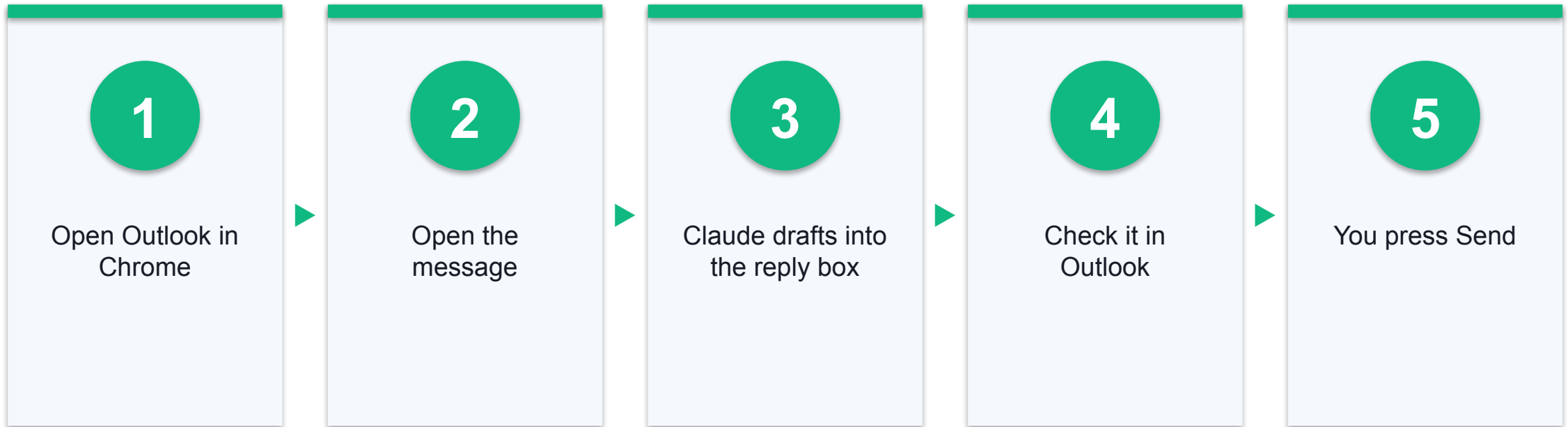
Claude in Chrome works on the page in front of you. Open a staff message in Outlook web, have Claude draft the reply into the real compose box, check it, and decide whether it goes.

You'll build

A reviewed reply drafted in Outlook on the web, sent only after you approved it or deliberately left in Drafts.

Tools: Claude for Chrome, Outlook on the web, per-action approval

Lab 10 — Process Map



Lab 10 — Professional Practice

1

Chrome sees the page

Claude in Chrome works on whatever is open in the browser, so the message must be on screen.

2

Approve each action

Manually approve means Claude asks before it touches the page. Never turn that off.

3

The draft is real

It lands in the Outlook compose box, not in a chat window.

4

Sending stays yours

Claude drafts. A person reads it and presses Send.

Draft an Outlook Reply with Claude in Chrome

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

A reply was drafted into the Outlook compose box, the recipient and every fact were checked, anything unsupported is marked 'need to check', and the message was either sent after approval or deliberately left in Drafts. Permission mode stayed on Manually approve throughout.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Add Skills and Connectors to the Project

LAB 13

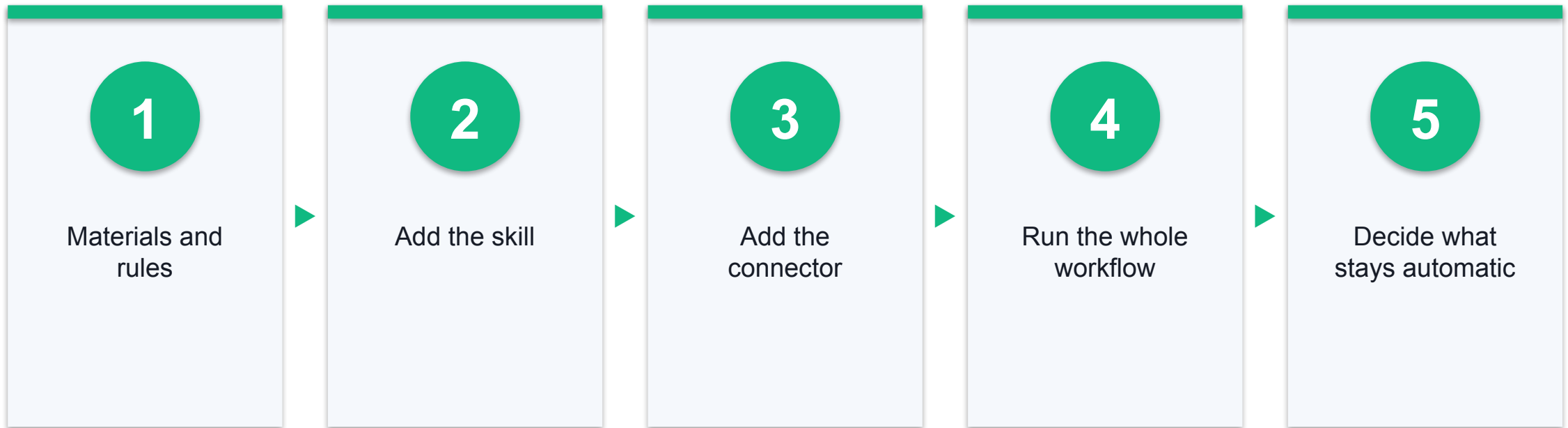
The project holds the materials and the rules. Add the hr-policy-draft skill so it knows your method, and the Microsoft 365 connector so it can reach real files and mail. Then run the full HR workflow end to end.

You'll build

An HR project with materials, standing rules, a skill and a connector, running one request that produces a policy draft, a summary and an Outlook draft.

Tools: Claude Projects, Claude Skills, Microsoft 365 connector, Cowork

Lab 13 — Process Map



Lab 13 — Professional Practice

1

Three things, one workspace

Materials say what to work on, the skill says how, the connector says where else to look.

2

One request, many steps

The project can draft, summarise and prepare mail without you moving between apps.

3

More reach, more care

A connector reads real company content, so the read-only boundary matters more, not less.

4

Automatic is a choice

Decide deliberately which steps may run unattended and which always need a person.

Add Skills and Connectors to the Project

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

The project has the hr-policy-draft skill enabled and the connector state recorded. One request produced a policy draft following the skill's rules, a headcount summary naming its source files, and an unsent Outlook draft. Nothing was sent, and you have written which steps may run unattended and which always need a person.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

Upload a Shared Skill for Slides

LAB 14

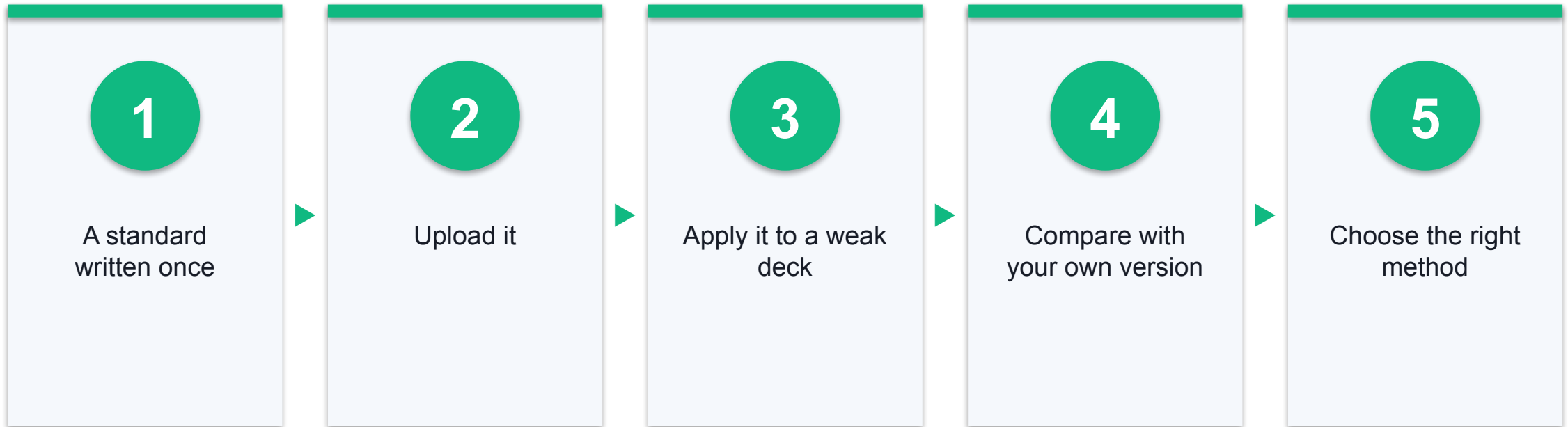
Your company has a house standard for decks, written once and shared as a file. Upload it as a skill and apply it to a weak draft deck.

You'll build

An uploaded deck-design-standard skill, and a rebuilt deck where every title states a conclusion.

Tools: Claude Skills, Claude for PowerPoint, Upload a skill

Lab 14 — Process Map



Lab 14 — Professional Practice

1

Upload a skill

Use this when the standard already exists and the team should share it.

2

One house standard

Everyone's deck looks like the company wrote it.

3

Read before you upload

A shared skill applies someone else's rules to your work.

4

Three ways to create

Write it, have Claude create it, or upload one someone else wrote.

Upload a Shared Skill for Slides

✓ ACCEPTANCE CHECK

The deck-design-standard skill was uploaded from the supplied file, running it changed every slide title to a conclusion and added source notes, the slide master is unchanged, and slide 1's speaker notes say which of the ways of creating a skill you would use and why.

INSPECT

Open the native artifact and challenge its sources, formulas, structure and versions.

RECONCILE

Confirm every material figure or claim against the approved evidence location.

ENDORSE

Record the named reviewer before accepting, saving, releasing or sending the work.

TOPIC RECAP

Recap — Staff Questions, Repeatable Work and Advanced Claude

1

Capability — Invoke a saved skill from Word so it reads the Excel workbook and writes the figures into the document.

2

Evidence retained — A completed quarterly update with figures drawn from the workbook, saved as a final copy.

3

Capability — Sort a set of staff messages by what each one needs, and draft one reply for approval.

4

Evidence retained — Every message sorted, one reply drafted, the person who would approve it named, and the reply created as an Outlook draft ready for review.

5

Capability — Have Claude read across a folder of HR files and write one summary, reporting what the files disagree on rather than resolving it.

6

Evidence retained — A two-page people summary built only from the folder, naming the file behind every claim, with disagreements reported rather than settled.



WRAP-UP

Course Summary & Next Steps

What You Achieved

1

Pick the right place

Choose the right place to use Claude for an HR task.

2

Decide what Claude reads

Decide what staff information Claude may read, and what it must never change.

3

Ask clearly

Write a request that says what you want, what to use, what to leave alone and when to stop.

4

Plan the hiring

Write a hiring plan in Word using only what the brief actually says.

5

Check the policy wording

Draft leave and flexible-work policy wording that flags every point needing legal review.

What You Achieved (cont.)

6

People numbers

Build a headcount and turnover analysis in Excel using live formulas.

7

Tell leadership

Build a leadership update deck where every slide title states a conclusion.

8

Handle the inbox

Sort the HR inbox and draft one reply ready for approval.

9

One folder, one summary

Have Claude read one folder and write a people summary that says where each fact came from.

10

Automate the update

Automate a weekly people update on your own computer.

What You Achieved (cont.)

11

Save it as a Skill

Save a working method as a Skill so the whole team applies the same standard.

12

Connect SharePoint

Use the Microsoft 365 connector to find HR files stored in SharePoint.

13

Add a plugin

Add a plugin, and judge when a task needs one and when it does not.

Keep Practising After the Course

1

Re-run the labs on your own machine — repetition is what makes the skills stick.

2

Apply the techniques to a real process or project in your own organisation.

3

Your course material stays available at <https://lms-tms.tertiaryinfotech.com/>.

4

Explore the follow-on courses at www.tertiarycourses.com.sg.

Selected References & Further Learning

1

Claude for Microsoft 365 overview

claude.com

2

Claude for Microsoft 365 add-ins overview

claude.com

3

Use Claude for Word

claude.com

4

Use Claude for Outlook

claude.com

5

Get started with Claude in Chrome

support.claude.com

6

Claude in Chrome permissions guide

support.claude.com

Thank You — Keep the Workflow Governed

Carry one connected evidence chain from source to decision.

1

BUILD

Create useful native Word, Excel and PowerPoint work products.

2

VERIFY

Trace claims, formulas, charts, recipients and assumptions to evidence.

3

APPROVE

Keep final save, release and send decisions with the authorised human.